

Xiao Zhang

PHD IN ECONOMICS · APPLIED MICROECONOMIST

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Profile

Applied microeconomist with a PhD in Economics from the University of Glasgow and strong training in applied econometrics, causal inference, and empirical research design. Experienced in applying rigorous econometric approaches to complex empirical questions, including counterfactual construction, identification assessment, robustness analysis, and heterogeneous treatment effects. Strong interest in applying quantitative economic analysis to competition, regulatory, and other evidence-intensive economic questions, with the ability to communicate complex economic findings clearly and effectively.

Education

University of Glasgow
PHD IN ECONOMICS

Glasgow, UK
2021–2026

- Research focused on applied microeconomics, causal inference, and policy evaluation using longitudinal microdata.

University of Glasgow
MSC IN FINANCIAL ECONOMICS

Glasgow, UK
2019–2020

Tianjin University of Finance and Economics
BSC IN FINANCE (REAL ESTATE FINANCE)

Tianjin, China
2015–2019

Selected Research

China's Universal Two-Child Policy and Health Outcomes

JOB MARKET PAPER

- Designed and implemented a Difference-in-Differences strategy using large longitudinal survey data to estimate the causal effects of China's Universal Two-Child Policy.
- Constructed credible counterfactual comparisons, assessed key identification assumptions, and estimated heterogeneous treatment effects across population groups.
- Built and validated panel datasets in Stata, implemented econometric models, conducted estimation and robustness analyses, and translated empirical results into clear economic and policy conclusions.

Selected Research Output

Publication. Zhang, X., Battisti, M. and Proto, E. (2023). "COVID-19 and mental health in China: the effects of personality." *Journal of Epidemiology and Community Health*.

Conference Presentation. Zhang, X. (2024). "Do Personal Income and Household Income per Capita Affect Life Satisfaction Differently?" Scottish Economic Society Annual Conference, Glasgow, UK.

Technical Skills

Econometric Methods: Applied econometrics; causal inference; Difference-in-Differences; Regression Discontinuity; Instrumental Variables; panel data methods; heterogeneous treatment effects

Software: Stata (advanced); R (working proficiency); SQL (intermediate); Python (developing); Microsoft Excel

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (professional fluency)

Teaching & Communication Experience

University of Glasgow
GRADUATE TEACHING ASSISTANT

Glasgow, UK
2022–2025

- Taught economics and quantitative methods, supporting and mentoring students and adapting explanations of complex economic and empirical concepts to varied technical backgrounds.

Awards & Professional Recognition

Cairncross PhD Scholarship (2021), Adam Smith Business School and University of Glasgow;

Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA) (2024).